

Emotion Identification Worksheet

DBT Emotion Regulation Module

Describe the emotion you are experiencing. Be as specific as possible. There are no wrong answers.

Emotion Name:

What word best describes what you're feeling? (e.g., sadness, anger, shame, fear, joy)

Intensity (0-100):

How intense is this emotion right now?

Prompting Event:

What happened right before you felt this emotion?

Interpretation:

What thoughts or beliefs came up? What did the event mean to you?

Body Sensations:

Where do you feel this emotion in your body? What does it feel like physically?

Action Urge:

What does this emotion make you want to do?

What You Did:

What action did you actually take?

Aftereffect:

How did the emotion and your actions affect you afterward?

ABC PLEASE Checklist

Reducing Vulnerability to Negative Emotions

Check each item you practiced today. These skills reduce your vulnerability to intense negative emotions over time. Aim to practice daily.

A — Accumulate Positive Experiences

- ☐ Did something enjoyable today
- ☐ Worked toward a long-term goal
- ☐ Engaged in a pleasant activity mindfully

B — Build Mastery

- ☐ Did something challenging
- ☐ Practiced a skill or hobby
- ☐ Accomplished something (even small)

C — Cope Ahead

- ☐ Identified an upcoming difficult situation
- ☐ Planned how to cope with it
- ☐ Rehearsed/visualized coping successfully

PLEASE Skills — Taking Care of Your Body

- ☐ PL — Treated Physical iLLness (took meds, saw doctor)
- ☐ E — Ate balanced meals (no skipping, no binging)
- ☐ A — Avoided mood-altering substances
- ☐ S — Got adequate Sleep (7-9 hours)
- ☐ E — Exercised (at least 20 minutes)

Opposite Action Guide

Acting opposite to your emotional urge

When your emotion does not fit the facts, or when acting on the emotion would be harmful, use opposite action. Act ALL THE WAY opposite — including body posture, facial expression, and tone of voice.

Emotion	Urge	Opposite Action
Fear	Avoid, escape, freeze	Approach what you fear (gradually). Stay present. Don't avoid.
Anger	Attack, yell, criticize	Gently avoid. Be kind. Take a timeout. Empathize.
Sadness	Withdraw, isolate, be passive	Get active. Reach out to others. Do things that build mastery.
Shame	Hide, avoid, keep secrets	Share with someone trustworthy. Hold your head up. Repeat the behavior (if not harmful).
Guilt	Avoid the person, punish yourself	Apologize/repair. Commit to not repeating. Let it go.

Practice Exercise:

Emotion I want to work with: _____

My opposite action plan:
